

FREE CONTRACTOR RESOURCE

THE CONTRACTOR'S GUIDE TO SPEC-PERFECT DUCTWORK

A 1-page checklist of the most common ductwork installation mistakes — and how custom fabrication locks out leaks, balances airflow, and trims energy bills for the life of the building.

■ COMMON INSTALL MISTAKES TO AVOID

- ✓ **Unsealed or taped-only seams.** Cloth & mastic tape fail within years. Specify sealed seams and mechanically locked joints.
- ✓ **Sharp, unradiused bends.** 90° hard corners choke airflow and spike static pressure. Use long-radius elbows and gradual transitions.
- ✓ **Oversized or undersized ducts.** Wrong CFM means noise, hot/cold spots, and wasted fan energy. Size to Manual D, not rule-of-thumb.
- ✓ **Excess flex run.** Flex duct over 5' straight, or any kinked run, cripples airflow. Keep flex short; hard-pipe the rest.
- ✓ **No turning vanes in mains.** Trunk turns without vanes create turbulence and uneven branch feeds. Always vaned.
- ✓ **Skipping the pressure test.** Never sign off without a leakage test. If you can't test it, you can't trust it.

THE PAYOFF

Up to 30% lower energy bills

Properly sealed, aerodynamically engineered custom ductwork can cut HVAC energy use by 20–30% — and keeps saving every month for the life of the system.

■ HOW CUSTOM FAB FIXES IT

- ✓ Seams Pittsburgh-locked & sealed — zero-leak guaranteed.
- ✓ Long-radius bends engineered to your CFM.
- ✓ Exact-fit transitions — no field butchery.

■ SPEC IT RIGHT

- ✓ Call out SMACNA seal class on the plans.
- ✓ Require a leakage test at commissioning.
- ✓ Send us the load calc — we size to it.